

EMCH380 – Project Management Teamwork

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Slides are developed from instructor's notes and other references.

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What are Teams All About?

Project Management – Teamwork

WHAT ARE TEAMS ALL ABOUT?

- **Team characteristic 1: Shared purpose or common goal**
 - People with different abilities, talents, experience, and backgrounds have come together for a shared purpose or common goal

What's the common goal for a team you are currently involved with?

- **Team characteristic 2: People have to work together**
 - Teams' purposes can't be easily achieved- if at all- by people working by themselves
 - People need other people to achieve the goal. That's another characteristic of your team
 - Different viewpoints and knowledge mean more brainpower is focused on achieving the goal
 - When all that talent is pooled effectively, no obstacle stands a chance

Can you list the unique contribution each person brings to the team?

WHAT ARE TEAMS ALL ABOUT?

- **Team characteristic 3: A payoff or benefit to everyone on the team**
 - The work of the team- achieving the purpose or the goal-benefits everyone on the team, directly or indirectly
 - Not every team starts off with a feeling of commitment.
 - Some people feel skeptical about teams because they've never experienced how satisfying a good team can be when working towards a common goal.

Can you think of the benefit to you if your team works effectively and achieves its goal?

GOOD TEAMS AND NOT-SO GOOD TEAMS

- Being on a team doesn't guarantee success
- Effective teams take work on every member's part
- Everyone has to be a team player

GOOD TEAMS AND NOT-SO GOOD TEAMS

Question	Indicator	Good Team Experience	Not-So Good Team Experience
Did members show up on time?	Members arrive on time?	Members are prompt because they know others will be	Members drift in sporadically and some leave early
Did members come prepared?	Members prepared?	Members are prepared and know what to expect	Members are unclear what the agenda is
Were the meetings organized?	Meeting organized?	Members follow a planned agenda	The agenda is tossed aside, and freewheeling discussion ensues
Did everyone contribute equally?	Members contribute equally?	Members give each other a chance to speak; quiet members are encouraged	Some members always dominate the discussion; some are reluctant to speak their minds
Did discussions help the team make decisions?	Discussions help members make decisions?	Members learn from others' points of view, new facts are discussed, creative ideas evolve, and alternatives emerge	Members reinforce their belief in their own points of view, or their decisions were made long before the meeting

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GOOD TEAMS AND NOT-SO GOOD TEAMS

Question	Indicator	Good Team Experience	Not-So Good Team Experience
What happened when members disagreed?	Any Disagreement?	Members follow a conflict resolution process established as part of the team's policies	Conflict turns to argument, angry words, emotion, blaming
Was there more cooperation or more conflict?	More cooperation or more conflict?	Cooperation is clearly an import ingredient	Conflict flares openly, as well as simmering below the surface
How committed were the members to the ideas or decisions made?	Commitment to decisions?	Members reach a consensus before leaving	Compromise is the best outcome possible; some members don't care about the result
Did people have good feeling about the team?	Member feelings after team decision?	Members satisfied, valued for their ideas	Members glad it's over, not sure of results of outcome
Did members support the team's decisions after the meeting?	Member support decision afterward?	Members are committed to implementation	Some members second-guess or undermine the team's decisions

WHAT ARE TEAMS ALL ABOUT?

1. **Team Constitution** (*Section II*)

- Members help develop, follow, and enforce the team's own pre-established policies and procedures- the team's constitution
- The effective team develops its own rules about how it will conduct business
- These rules range from simple ones, like having members arrive on time and notifying attendees about the agenda, to complex policies, such as how to resolve conflict

2. **Team Collaboration** (*Section III*)

- It is the responsibility of all team members to make sure that everyone gets a chance to offer ideas- even risky or silly- sounding ideas- without being ridiculed or ignored.

WHAT ARE TEAMS ALL ABOUT?

3. Team Consensus (*Section IV*)

- Consensus is a stronger and more powerful outcome than compromise
- It is the responsibility of team members to stick with a discussion until all issues are unraveled, consensus among members is formed, and reservations are resolved.

4. Team Cooperation in Dealing with Conflict (*Section V*)

- The effective team member knows that conflict is natural and that a full, far-reaching and fact-filled discussion about the conflict will eventually lead members to a clearer understanding of different points of view
- It is the responsibility of all team members to approach conflict and disagreement non-defensively and to discuss differences open mindedly
- On a team, no one 'wins' an argument.

INDIVIDUAL RESPONSIBILITY

- Establish and enforce the team's own basic rules, policies, and procedures, and comply with them for the sake of the team
- Ensure that unusual, risky, or innovative ideas are offered and developed without negative judgment in a relaxed, enjoyable atmosphere
- Encourage decision making based on facts, direct experience, and logic that explores the differences and similarities among team members' points of view
- Remain flexible, non-defensive, and open minded when disagreements occur; don't let conflict linger and develop into arguments.

I

Team Constitution

Project Management – Teamwork

WRITING THE TEAM CONSTITUTION

- Just as the constitution of a country defines how the government will work, a team's constitution establishes operating principles, policies, and ground rules that everyone on the team learns, understands, and is willing to comply with.

II

HOW DOES THE TEAM WRITE A CONSTITUTION?

Method one: Future-Forward- The Team Victory Party

II

- ▶ One way to approach the task of writing a team constitution is to imagine the future success of the team and work backward from there, defining what it took to get there.
- ▶ From this future perspective, look back and ask:
 - What were our meetings like? How were they conducted?
 - How did we reach high-quality decisions?
 - Who was involved and when?
 - What indicators told us we were doing a good job as a team?
 - How did people feel about being on the team? Why did they feel that way?
 - How were crises and problems handled? What was the atmosphere in the meeting?
 - How were differences of opinion handled? How did people feel about discussions?
 - What role did the team leader play?

HOW DOES THE TEAM WRITE A CONSTITUTION?

Method two: Anticipating predictable problems

II

- ▶ Another way to develop a team constitution is to examine the list of predictable and frequent problems any team can expect, especially in its early stages. The team's task is to come up with ideas that avoid these problems—ideas that everyone can agree with, ideas that are tailored to your own situation.
- ▶ Here is a list of some typical team problems:
 - Important people not included
 - Undisciplined behavior at team meetings
 - Long, Drawn-out discussions: Some lengthy discussions are necessary when making a complex decision. On the other hand, when these discussions are unproductive and rambling, time is wasted, and people become disinterested and eventually agree to anything simply to get out of the meeting.
 - Complaining
 - The dominating team member

CONSTITUTION EXAMPLE

- **Article one:** we will always be on time for meetings. Right on time. If we must be late or absent, we will inform the team leader or a team member at least a day in advance.
- **Article two:** we will always come to meetings prepared to work on the agenda that we will receive before the meeting. Our preparation and data collection will be complete, and we will be ready to discuss the issues on the agenda
- **Article three:** we will always respect the opinions and feelings of all individuals. Each member has equal participation in our meetings. When discussing team business, members should expect to contribute to discussions and be listened to with respect
- **Article four:** we will always avoid blaming people for the shortcomings of our team. If our team somehow fails to do its tasks properly, we will examine our team process and attempt to improve it. If individuals are having trouble meeting their commitments, the team will support them in every way possible.
- **Article five:** members will support the decisions of the team after they are made. Undermining team decisions or second-guessing and badmouthing the team and its work outside the team setting to nonmembers is unacceptable behavior.

CONSTITUTION EXAMPLE

- **Article six:** members will live up to their team commitments, recognizing that failure to do so affects the whole team's progress. When in jeopardy of not meeting their obligations, members will notify the team in time for others to take supportive action.
- **Article seven:** when faced with a decision, we will first decide how to make the decision. Our general rule is to (1) state the problem, (2) discuss different ideas, (3) examine the benefits and risks associated with different approaches, and (4) select an approach we can all support. Other methods may be appropriate.
- **Article eight:** we will deal with conflict in a productive way. Our general rule for conflict is to understand the problem as best as we can from each side's perspective. To do that, we will listen to all sides of the conflict, looking for facts and evidence. If there is still a conflict about facts, we will gather additional data. When the problem is understood, the team will help those in conflict create alternative approaches. If misunderstandings are not corrected through this approach, we will call a special meeting to address the conflict.
- **Article nine:** we recognize that working on a team usually results in high-quality ideas and decisions, as well as fun. If we find we are not experiencing these benefits of teamwork, we will pause to assess how we are working together until we better understand our team and our work.

EXPANDING WHAT YOU HAVE LEARNED

- Use the answers to the following questions to help you and your team prepare to write an effective constitution. Think about these answers by yourself or bring them to a team meeting
 - What kinds of persistent problems is your team experiencing during meetings? Can you trace any of these problems to lack of clear ground rules? What would fix these problems?
 - Team members blame each other for things not done or done incorrectly. How could blaming be avoided by writing clear rules about how the team works together?
 - Does your team meet weekly? daily? How does the team know it is meeting frequently enough? What kind of problems can be avoided by meeting more frequently?
 - What is your typical agenda? If you had to conduct a meeting in 30 minutes, what would have to change? How about five minutes? What ground rules will help your team conduct a much more efficient meeting in the allotted time?
 - Can you list at least three ideas for orienting new members to how you team works? What are some of the unwritten rules new members should know?

Team Collaboration & Creativity

Project Management – Teamwork

HOW TO GET IDEAS ON THE TABLE?

- Solving a problem as a group is different from solving a problem as an individual. The team has the power of different ideas and points of view. When team members collaborate effectively, ideas from different people produce creative alternatives and unique approaches to problems

III

HOW TO BRING IDEAS TO LIFE

What to do	How to do it
1. Listen with interest and respect to what members say	Use body-language . Demonstrate active listening skills to let members know you're tuned in and attentive. Allow members to complete their statements without interruption or distractions
2. Pursue what is interesting about unique and different ideas	Find the best characteristic of the idea being offered. Build on ideas by repeating the unique characteristic and support or expand it. Encourage the member offering the idea to keep explaining what's on his/her mind. Ask follow-up questions.
3. Acknowledge and record every idea as it comes up	Use flipchart or chalkboard to list ideas. All team members should acknowledge contributions.

HOW TO BRING IDEAS TO LIFE

What to do	How to do it
4. Ask others to go beyond the obvious	encourage members to stretch their imaginations. Ask the team to do a loosening up exercise, like collecting uses for a marshmallow. Give people permission to be creative. Remember, the first solution is not necessarily the best solution
5. Collect a quantity of ideas. Quality will soon become evident.	Ask members to state as many ideas as possible. The team will have time to refine them later. Keep asking “any other idea?” and wait until they emerge. Stick with it... Don’t be discouraged if ideas develop slowly
6. Allow time for thinking	Don’t confuse silence with inattentiveness. Silence is the sound of thinking. Take a break or a walk. Come back tomorrow. Ignore periods of confusion and frustration. They’re natural.

III

HOW TO BRING IDEAS TO LIFE

What to do	How to do it
7. Ask critics for ideas and suggestions	If someone criticizes an idea, ask him or her to offer a new idea in its place or build on the idea in question.
8. Encourage people to ask “what if” questions	Use a metaphor. Remove constraints. Draw the problem as a picture.
9. Avoid criticism and judgment of ideas	Advise naysayers about the team constitution. Treat all ideas equally as they are expressed. Reward people for their contributions
10. Have fun.	Order a pizza. Wear casual clothes, sit on the floor, play music, tell jokes.

III

COLLABORATION & CREATIVITY

III

- Collaboration Means Permission to Be Creative
 - Everyone can be creative-don't allow your preconceptions to color your view of teammates' capabilities.
 - Give permission to everybody to be creative in an effort to solve problems.
 - Allow plenty of time for idea development.
 - Never dismiss an idea for seeming silly or frivolous. These are opportunities to develop new approaches.
 - Listen to all ideas.
 - Encourage teammates to play with concepts and ideas even before a serious idea emerges.
 - Perhaps break up heavy sessions with less serious activities to ease tension and change the pace.
 - After a tension-reducing break, go back to the problem with renewed energy.

Team Consensus

Project Management – Teamwork

DECISIONS THE TEAM CAN STAND BEHIND

- A compromise is a way of getting a decision people can live with.
 - Generally, the result is all right, but not terrific. Some words that you might associate with a compromise might be, half-hearted, reluctant, settlement, concession, or arrangement. A camel is a horse designed by committee
- There may be some winners and losers in a compromise decision. When people make a decision that they are not a 100% committed to, they may feel half-hearted and reluctant about putting that decision into action.

IV

CONSENSUS – MAKING LASTING DECISIONS

- If a decision needs to be made by your team, do you:
 - Fold your arms and watch the argument unfold?
 - Argue forcefully for your optimal time slot?
 - Discuss what people think and see how the group feels?
 - Decide the decision is too complex to make , so you recommend saying no to flexible scheduling?

CONSENSUS – MAKING LASTING DECISIONS

- Opting out of making decisions because they appear complex or difficult only means that opportunities for improving work and the quality of work slip by or, even worse, be made by someone else.
- Arguing on the basis of self-interest will only lead to more arguing, delaying a decision until individuals are worn down and willing to compromise, and you now know where that leads.
- When a decision requires a group commitment, this kind of agreement is called consensus.

IV

BUILDING A SHARED VIEW

- Basically, the process of achieving consensus involves getting people with different points of view to start seeing things in similar way or at least narrowing their differences
- Team members can practice consensus skills any time the group needs to reach a decision that everyone must buy into.
- The following table shows ways to narrow differences in points of view among team members

IV

BUILDING A SHARED VIEW – 10 TEAM CONSENSUS SKILLS

What to do	How to do it
1. Ask everyone how he/she feels about the situation and why.	Go around the table and give everyone his/her say. Stop team members who are dominating discussion, and poll everyone else. Ask members who are silent what they think.
2. Ask for facts, definitions, or explanations, and try to uncover what different thoughts or words really mean to team members	Ask members to explain their views. Focus on words. Ask “how do you know that” when faced with questionable statements.
3. Clarify discrepancies of opinion with facts.	State facts and ask other team members to compare opinions with members to support competing points of view with facts. If there are no available facts, ask members to gather data before continuing.

BUILDING A SHARED VIEW – 10 TEAM CONSENSUS SKILLS

IV

What to do	How to do it
4. Modify your views when faced with compelling facts and opinions.	Listen to the facts underlying differing points of view. Test the facts being presented against your viewpoint. Weight the impact on you and the team of continuing to resist ideas in the face of convincing facts. Try on the other point of view and see how it feels. Is it really that different from yours? Are the consequences acceptable?
5. Identify similarities and differences among the points of view in the team.	Make a list of similarities and differences on a flipchart or chalkboard. Ask different members to state what is similar about their ideas. Crystallize the difference among team members in a simple statement.
6. Reinforce open-mindedness- that is the willingness to listen to other views-and the need for cooperation.	Remind members about the team constitution's rules concerning open discussion. Give people time to talk. Make sure they have said what is on their minds. Review the team's goals from time to time and stress the need to work together to come to agreement.

3

BUILDING A SHARED VIEW – 10 TEAM CONSENSUS SKILLS

What to do	How to do it
7. Remain nondefensive when challenged and avoid emotional encounters	Stay silent and calm when being criticized. Wait until the other member has finished before commenting. Take notes reflecting the other member's points. Summarize the other member's opinion in your own words. If the meeting is getting emotional, ask for a short recess, take a walk, try to relax. Be emphatic with other's views.
8. List the positive and negative aspects or consequences of each point of view.	Assume the team has adopted a particular point of view. Ask members to discuss the advantages and disadvantages. Repeat the process with the next opinion. Explore the risks associated with each idea. Test how realistic different people's assessment of the risks are.

IV

BUILDING A SHARED VIEW – 10 TEAM CONSENSUS SKILLS

IV

What to do	How to do it
9. Be sure that each team member participates.	Go around the table and ask all the members what they think. Members have a responsibility to speak their minds
10. Through discussion, define the level of risk associated with a decision and develop an approach that minimizes that risk for everyone.	Ask people what concerns them about a specific course of action. If concerns are based on a misperception or misunderstanding, explain the facts. Balance the advantages and risks of each approach. Ask the team what level of risk it is willing to accept.

Team Conflict Management

Project Management – Teamwork

LEARNING TO MANAGE CONFLICT

- What do you think of when you think of the word conflict?
- Say you're in a team meeting, presenting your ideas. You think you've been pretty smart. Even brilliant. Someone says, "I don't agree. I don't think we should do that at all. In Fact, we ought to do it this way." How do you feel?

V

LEARNING TO MANAGE CONFLICT

- Conflict usually is not a positive experience. It often makes its appearance through angry words, pounding fists, emotional and loud voices, hurt feelings, withdrawal, and even confusion. Ideas stop flowing, people stop talking, things stop happening.
- Whenever a diverse group of people come together to work as a team toward a common goal, their ideas about how to get things done are going to be different. There will be conflict.

AVOIDING UNNECESSARY CONFLICT

- Look at the following list of the typical sources of conflict for a team. Can you identify which sources might be valuable and which ones unnecessary and suggest how to avoid an unnecessary source of conflict?

V

AVOIDING UNNECESSARY CONFLICT

- Are the following typical sources of conflict valuable or unnecessary? If unnecessary, how to avoid?
 1. Goals and rewards differ among team members. Self-interest predominates.
 2. Members view the business from their own functional view (e.g. finance, operations, sales), without seeing the big picture.
 3. Members haven't been told to cooperate, or they believe that the team is a chance to win while others lose.
 4. New members join the team late and bring up ideas already addressed by the team.
 5. Members think they are right because they have facts or experience other team members don't have.
 6. Members like to test ideas by challenging decisions and authority.
 7. Some members have values and beliefs about work that sometimes are contrary the group.

LEARNING TO MANAGE CONFLICT

- **Goals and Rewards are Different:** This source of conflict is unnecessary. Team members, even those from different parts of an organization should be accountable for their teamwork and should be rewarded for its success.
- **Functional views of the Business Prevail:** While you might say it is valuable to have different views around team table, if there is not a shared common view of how all the pieces of the business fit together as a system, the resulting conflict can be unproductive. A team can avoid this unnecessary conflict by developing a systems diagram-a map-of how each function contributes and is linked to serving the customer. This is an important ground rule to establish before teamwork can be effective.

LEARNING TO MANAGE CONFLICT

- **People Want to Win:** Politics is a reality in businesses. A well-thought-out team constitution may go a long way in breaking down these barriers.
- **New Members Join the Team Late:** New members should be briefed and thoroughly oriented to the team, its goals, the team constitution, the history of its achievements, its strengths and future plans.
- **Members Think they are Right:** Conflicts based on different facts and views of facts are extremely valuable. Team collaboration and consensus skills apply here.

LEARNING TO MANAGE CONFLICT

- **Members like to Test Ideas:** Although they may be annoying, the gadfly is another important and valuable source of conflict. Challenges, conflicting views, nay-saying, and off-the-wall hypothetical examples offer an opportunity to thoroughly examine the consequences of a decision.
- **Some Members have Different Values and Beliefs:** Like the gadfly, members with different values and beliefs force the team to look hard at their decisions. For example, a decision involving flexible work hours would not be valid unless a working parent with child-care responsibilities brought work and family issues to the team table.

V

FIVE WAYS TO RESOLVE CONFLICT

- **Bargaining**
- **Problem Solving**
- **Voting**
- **Research**
- **Third-Party mediation**

FIVE WAYS TO RESOLVE CONFLICT

- **Bargaining:** It is simply “if you do this, I’ll do that.” Call it horse-trading, basic politicking, dealing, or negotiating. Bargaining usually resolves conflicts through compromise.
- How to do it?
 - Before you begin, identify what your bargaining chips are, that is, what you’re willing to give up.
 - See if you can do the same thing for the other side. Speculate on what their bargaining chips are.
 - At the same time, decide your absolute minimum acceptable resolution, the limit of bargain beyond which you simply can not go.
 - Start the process by presenting the least valuable of your bargaining chips. Offer it (“If you do this, I’ll do that”), and see what happens.
- What types of conflict in your team can be effectively handled by bargaining? Why would bargaining help conflict resolution in your team? Why would it hinder conflict resolution?

FIVE WAYS TO RESOLVE CONFLICT

- **Problem Solving:** This is one of the most objective ways of dealing with conflict. The key is to get different sides to define the real problem everyone is trying to solve.
- How to do it?
 - Make sure everyone involved in the conflict participates in the problem-solving process.
 - Restate the goal of the team in trying to resolve the conflict. “Remember our purpose is to raise money for the fund drive as quickly as possible.”
 - Ask each side of the conflict to present its view. Probe for facts that have led to those points of view and avoid arguing.
 - As a result of hearing these different views, state the problem. “We have two different opinions about how to ask employees for money. One is direct and demanding, requiring a specific amount, the other is more open ended. Is that our problem?”
 - Develop alternatives, using team collaboration skills. Be creative and encourage all members to participate.
 - Evaluate the alternatives and select one that works for everyone.

FIVE WAYS TO RESOLVE CONFLICT

- **Voting:** Yes, simply voting for one side or the other is a legitimate way to resolve conflict. It's the parliamentary approach. Of course, there are winners and losers in a voting situation. A voted resolution to a conflict may have even less support than a compromise.

V

FIVE WAYS TO RESOLVE CONFLICT

- **Research:** Many teams argue about issues based on lots of opinion and few hard facts. One objective way to resolve these endless discussions is to gather data through research and interpret the findings. If the findings are inconclusive, then either conduct more research or accept the ambiguity and start problem solving

V

FIVE WAYS TO RESOLVE CONFLICT

- **Third-Party Mediation:** Seek the counsel of an objective third party. Objectivity is key. If the mediator appears biased, either toward one team member or a particular point of view, the process is undermined.
- How to Do it?
 - The team should identify who the objective, third-party mediator should be.
 - Before the mediation process, all parties must agree to abide by the results.
 - During mediation, each side will present its facts and opinions. The mediator will ask questions.
 - A good mediator will try to facilitate problem solving among the conflicting parties. Only when this fails to reach a breakthrough will the mediator make a final determination.
 - The team should reflect on the process, seeking to learn how to avoid the inflexibility that led to mediation instead of a team-generated resolution.

Summary & Self Assessment

Project Management – Teamwork

LECTURE SUMMARY

- Conflict is natural and it as an opportunity
- Manage conflict toward productive discussion, not arguments.
- Avoid unnecessary conflict by using your team constitution.
- Clarify rules and procedures
- Resolve conflict By
 - Bargaining
 - Problem Solving
 - Voting
 - Research
 - Third-Party Mediation
- Develop trust is the secret ingredient that makes conflict productive.
- Conflict can lead to greater cooperation.

SELF-ASSESSMENT

This self-assessment will highlight areas you may want to focus on as you begin to develop team player skills

1. T F The three common characteristics of a team are shared goals, people having to work together, and a benefit to everyone.
2. T F The team should get right down to business and start making decisions as soon as it is clear about its goals.
3. T F Laughter and silence are two useful and important aspects of a team that is collaborating to solve a serious business problem.
4. T F A compromise is better than consensus.
5. T F Conflict on teams is beneficial if members understand how to manage it.
6. T F One way to be sure team members arrive at meetings on time is to establish a rule in the team constitution.
7. T F Making announcements is the most effective use of team meeting time.
8. T F When members of a team are committed to a decision, it means they have reached a compromise.
9. T F Only the members who know the facts should contribute to the solution
10. T F A stakeholder is anyone who is affected by the decisions of a team.

SELF-ASSESSMENT - ANSWERS

1. **True.** A team is any group with common goals, a task that must be done by more than one person, and some kind of payoffs or benefits for every member.
2. **False.** The team should first develop rules for governing its activities.
3. **True.** Problem solving and creativity inspire both laughter and thought.
4. **False.** Members are committed to consensus decisions. Compromise implies some are giving up what they want.
5. **True.** Differences among members can be channeled and managed to produce high quality results.
6. **True.** A team constitution is a set of rules that governs the team's activities.
7. **False.** Making announcements, although common in team meetings, is not the best use of meeting time.
8. **False.** A consensus is a decision that team members are committed to.
9. **False.** Anyone involved on a team or event outside the team can be part of the problem-solving process.
10. **True.** A stakeholder may not necessarily be on a team but may be impacted by the team's decisions.

Thank you for your attention!

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